Shiftwell (fictional) sells shift-scheduling software to multi-location businesses in India: restaurant chains, clinics, retail stores and gyms. Customers pay per location per year. Current ARR is ₹4.08 Cr across 8 active accounts.

Three kinds of people use Shiftwell at every customer:

Role	Who	What they do on Shiftwell	How often
Admin	Operations/HR at head office. (The one who signs and renews the annual contract with Shiftwell's sales team)	Adds locations and Location Manager accounts. Reads company-wide reports: labour hours, overtime cost, unfilled shifts. Does not build rosters or approve swaps.	A few times a month, on the web dashboard
Location Manager	Store, restaurant or clinic manager	Adds and removes Staff at their location and sets each Staff's role. Builds the weekly roster, publishes it, and approves or rejects every swap and leave request.	Daily, on mobile app
Staff	Frontline staff: cooks, nurses, store associates	Sees their shifts, requests swaps with colleagues, and applies for leave.	Several times a week, on the mobile app

Your situation. You joined Shiftwell's product team this week. The CEO forwards you three urgent requests from the three largest accounts, each asking for a different feature. The sales head wants all three built. Engineering has capacity for about 6 sprints this quarter (2 engineers, 1 designer). The engineering lead is on leave until next week, so some estimates are missing.

The CEO writes: *"I need your recommendation on what we will build this quarter and why. I'd rather have a clear call with stated assumptions than a perfect answer next month."*

Your task. Use the data pack below.

1. **Diagnose.** What is actually going on across these accounts? Separate what customers are asking for from what they need.
2. **Decide.** Recommend what Shiftwell should build this quarter. Say what you would not build, and what you would tell each of the three accounts.
3. **Build.** Make a small working prototype of the most important piece of your recommendation. A spreadsheet, a script, a no-code tool or a clickable flow all count. Use any AI tools you like.
4. **Persuade.** The sales head has shared a memo (their memo is in the data pack). Write them a reply.

Data pack

1. The three requests

Account	Request	Sent by
FreshBowl	"Let staff request shift swaps on WhatsApp, and let managers approve them there too."	Ops Director
CarePoint Clinics	"Stop anyone from being scheduled or swapped into a shift if a certificate their role requires has expired. For example, nurses need a valid BLS (Basic Life Support) certificate and nursing council registration."	Head of Compliance
UrbanMart	"Any shift that takes someone past 48 hrs/week must need regional manager approval."	VP HR

2. Active accounts (September 2026)

Account	Segment	Locations	ARR (₹ lakh)	Renewal due	Staff on app	Swap requests / month	Swaps approved within 24 hrs	Location Manager hrs / week on scheduling	Health (CS team)
UrbanMart	Retail	200	110	Aug 2027	5,200	3,100	64%	3.5	Healthy
FreshBowl	Restaurants	120	84	Jan 2027	3,600	2,900	38%	6.5	At risk
CarePoint Clinics	Clinics	40	60	Dec 2026	900	310	71%	4.0	At risk
QuickKart	Retail	90	48	Jun 2027	2,100	1,000	67%	3.0	Healthy
Spice Route	Restaurants	60	36	Mar 2027	1,500	1,400	41%	6.0	Watch
MedAxis Labs	Diagnostics	25	30	Feb 2027	450	90	80%	2.5	Healthy
FitZone	Gyms	50	22	Oct 2026	600	540	35%	5.5	At risk
Brew & Co	Cafes	35	18	Nov 2026	700	820	29%	7.0	At risk

3. Accounts lost in the last 12 months

Account	Segment	Locations	ARR lost (₹ lakh)	Reason recorded by sales	Swaps approved within 24 hrs (last 3 months)
StyleHub	Retail	70	30	Budget cuts	60%

TandooriTown	Restaurants	45	25	Price	22%
GreenLeaf Salads	Restaurants	30	16	Moved to RotaPro (has WhatsApp)	31%
PawsCare Vets	Clinics	15	9	Went back to spreadsheets	33%

4. Interview notes (collected by customer success last month)

- **FreshBowl, Ops Director (Admin):** "Our staff live on WhatsApp. I want swaps approved there. RotaPro already does this."
- **FreshBowl, store manager (Location Manager):** "I get 25–30 swap requests a night. I approve almost all of them without thinking. I only check if they're trained for the station and won't go into overtime."
- **FreshBowl, line cook (Staff):** "We find someone to swap with in our WhatsApp group in ten minutes. Then we wait a day for the manager to approve. Half the time we just swap and don't tell the app."
- **CarePoint, Head of Compliance (Admin):** "An auditor found two shifts covered by nurses with lapsed BLS certificates. One more finding and we face a penalty."
- **CarePoint, clinic manager (Location Manager):** "I track certificate expiry dates in my own Excel and check it every time I approve a swap."
- **UrbanMart, VP HR (Admin):** "Overtime is 9% of our wage bill. I want every shift over 48 hours a week to need regional approval."
- **GreenLeaf, former Head of Operations (Admin), exit call:** "Honestly it wasn't WhatsApp. Our managers couldn't keep up with approvals, and RotaPro let swaps go through automatically if the person was trained."

5. Memo from the sales head

> UrbanMart is our biggest account at ₹1.1 Cr, and their VP said they'd "look at options" if overtime rules don't ship. RotaPro launched WhatsApp approvals and we already lost GreenLeaf to them. We should build WhatsApp for FreshBowl and overtime rules for UrbanMart this quarter. Certificate tracking is niche: only clinics need it.

6. Engineering notes (from the last planning meeting)

- Today every swap goes to the Location Manager for manual approval. There are no rules; this is hard-coded.
- WhatsApp approvals: about 3 sprints. Needs WhatsApp Business API templates and costs roughly ₹0.35 per message.
- UrbanMart overtime approval as a custom build: about 2 sprints.
- Certificate expiry field that blocks scheduling: about 1 sprint.

- No estimates for anything else. The engineering lead is back next week.

Deliverables

Submit within 72 hours of receiving this brief. Plan for 3–4 hours of work; we value a clear, short answer over a long one.

#	Deliverable	Limit
1	Recommendation memo to the CEO	2 pages
2	Reply to the sales head	200 words
3	Assumptions list: every assumption you made where data was missing	Bullets
4	Build note: what the prototype does, how you built it, how you used AI, and what a real version would need from engineering	200 words
5	Working prototype link	Any tool (Link)
6	AI chat link (If you have used AI to solve) (Optional)	Any tool (Link)

Rules:

- AI tools are allowed and encouraged. Tell us which ones you used and for what. Be ready to explain every number and claim in person.
- Don't contact anyone to ask for more data. Where something is missing, assume and write it down.
- In the follow-up interview you will walk us through your recommendation for 5 minutes, then we'll discuss it.
- Final submission should be done in the form of a **Single PDF document.**